

Meridian Autoparts Inc.

Request for Proposal (RFP) — RM-2026-014

Supply of Raw Materials: Cold-Rolled Steel Coil & 5052 Aluminum Sheet

Issue Date: June 1, 2026 | Response Deadline: June 30, 2026 | Contract Term: 24 months

1. Scope of Work

Meridian Autoparts Inc. ('Meridian') operates a Tier-1 stamping and forming facility in Elkhart, Indiana, supplying structural body panels and brackets to three North American OEM assembly plants. Meridian is soliciting proposals from qualified raw material suppliers for the continuous supply of Cold-Rolled Steel (CRS) coil and 5052-H32 Aluminum sheet to feed its stamping lines beginning September 1, 2026. This RFP covers material supply only; tooling and logistics-provider selection are handled under separate agreements.

2. Material Specifications (Mandatory)

Req #	Material	Specification	Tolerance / Grade
REQ-01	Cold-Rolled Steel Coil	ASTM A1008, CS Type B	Thickness 0.8-2.5mm, ±0.03mm
REQ-02	Cold-Rolled Steel Coil	Min. yield strength 270 MPa	Coil width 900-1250mm
REQ-03	Aluminum Sheet	5052-H32 per ASTM B209	Thickness 1.0-3.0mm, ±0.05mm
REQ-04	Aluminum Sheet	Surface finish: Mill finish, oil-coated	Max. surface defect rate 0.5%
REQ-05	Both materials	Mill Test Certificates (MTC) per lot	EN 10204 Type 3.1
REQ-06	Both materials	Traceability to heat/lot number	Full chain of custody

3. Estimated Annual Volume

Material	Annual Volume	Delivery Frequency	Delivery Location
Cold-Rolled Steel Coil	18,000 metric tons	Weekly (JIT)	Elkhart, IN (Dock 3)
5052 Aluminum Sheet	4,200 metric tons	Bi-weekly	Elkhart, IN (Dock 3)

4. Pricing Submission Requirements

Proposals must include a line-item pricing table quoted in USD per metric ton, FOB Elkhart, IN, broken out by material grade/thickness band. Quotes must state whether pricing is fixed for the contract term or indexed to a published raw-material index (e.g., CRU CRC Index, LME Aluminum). If indexed, state the index, base price, and adjustment frequency. Include any minimum order quantity (MOQ), volume discount tiers, and fuel/energy surcharge policy.

5. Service Level Requirements

Req #	Requirement	Target
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SLA-01	On-time delivery rate	≥ 97% of scheduled deliveries
SLA-02	Order lead time (standard)	≤ 10 business days
SLA-03	Order lead time (expedite option)	≤ 3 business days, surcharge disclosed
SLA-04	Defect / non-conformance rate	≤ 0.3% by weight, with credit/return process
SLA-05	Minimum liability insurance	\$5,000,000 general liability
SLA-06	Business continuity plan	Documented, includes backup mill/source

6. Compliance & Certifications (Mandatory)

Bidders must hold and provide evidence of: IATF 16949 certification (or documented roadmap to certification within 12 months), ISO 14001 environmental management certification, and compliance with Meridian's Conflict Minerals policy (Section 1502 Dodd-Frank reporting for any tin, tantalum, tungsten, or gold content). Suppliers must also disclose country of melt/pour for all steel per Buy America / OEM regional-content requirements, where applicable.

7. Payment & Commercial Terms

Preferred payment terms are Net 60 from receipt of conforming goods. Proposals should state standard payment terms offered and any early-payment discount schedule. Meridian requires consignment or vendor-managed inventory (VMI) options to be described if available, as this is weighted favorably in scoring.

8. Evaluation Criteria & Weighting

Criterion	Weight
Price competitiveness	30%
Technical spec compliance	25%
Delivery reliability / SLA fit	20%
Certifications & compliance	15%
Commercial terms (payment, VMI)	10%